On one of our weekend jaunts, we chanced upon a very beautiful and scenic lake about 15 kilometres from Itanagar. It was a sorry spectacle to see the lake, known as 'Geykar Sinyi' or Ganga lake, and its surroundings in such an unkempt state. Even the inaugural plaque, carrying the name of a former governor, had creepers and undergrowth all around. Instead of a place to cherish nature's bounty, the area had something sinister about it. Hence, I decided to request the Indian Navy to send a team of divers so that we could do a hydrographic survey of the lake. Having done that, the navy was kind enough to mark the dangerous areas with colourful buoys. The next step was to procure some paddle boats. The state's tourism secretary was requested to get funds released so that they could place the order for boats. It was then brought to my notice that there was no electricity or water supply at this site. To make it into a worthwhile destination for tourists, a new power line and water pipelines had to be laid. Besides these, there was a languishing swimming pool project at this site which needed to be funded so that it could be completed. All these have been put into place on a fast-track basis, with constant nudging of the Raj Bhawan. This tourist facility has been leased out as part of the tourism department's public-private partnership scheme, and is today humming with activity. This complete transformation has been achieved within a period of two years. The downside of it is that young boys and girls are bunking school to romance in the environs of this enchanting lake!

I am convinced that Arunachal Pradesh has huge potential in apiculture too. Pure Himalayan organic honey has a huge demand and sells at a high premium. Therefore, we have taken the lead by setting up a few bee colonies in the Raj Bhawan itself. A lesser-known fact is that Punjab is the largest producer of honey in our country even though it has very little forest cover or flowers and no support of Himalayan flora. In Arunachal, we have all three, yet we produce a negligible quantity of honey, an aspect that I keep emphasizing to our people. There have been some encouraging developments in this field, and I hope to see my vision being realized one day. Further, seeing the potential for the production of